

Questions (Data Scientist):

- For Options A and B, are we expected to rule them out? What sort of proof does BC Wildfire Service expect that shows Option C as the best choice?
- If we are just looking at fires caused by humans vs. lightning strikes, would it be a good idea to drop the other cause categories including “Unknown”? Or does the client expect those nuances? The other two are “H-PB: Prescribed burn (human caused)” and “Re: Reburn” which seem outside the scope of the model.
- Since this is BC Wildfire Service, am I correct in assuming we disregard any entries that are in a province other than BC?

Manmeet (Client):

Hi Stin! I would say yes, rule out a and b if the data doesn't support them. look at whether human vs. lightning fires (and how big they get) actually change a lot depending on region, season, or ecozone. If they do, that's your proof. It means one size fits all education campaigns (a) or towers everywhere (b) aren't as smart as targeting the specific areas and times that actually need it, which is what option c lets us do. if the data looks pretty random and evenly spread out everywhere, then a or b would make more sense instead.

For the cause categories, yes, drop “H-PB: Prescribed burn (human caused)” and “Re: Reburn”, and I'd say drop unknown too since we can't predict a cause we don't even know. keep it to just h vs. l, that matches what we actually asked for. good catch! go ahead and put that in your assumptions log since the proposal didn't spell it out.

And yup, you're right, BC only. Anything outside BC isn't relevant to BCWS so filter those out.

Agreed upon timeline fits the one Mehdi has already laid out:

Tue Jul 21	Client proposal due
Wed Jul 22	Projects are assigned to students (instruction team reviews proposals and resolves conflicts)
Wed Aug 5	Checkpoint 1 — EDA on dataset. Submitted to instructor and shared with your assigned Client
Thu Aug 6	Client Check-in — Client responds to Checkpoint 1 with brief feedback
Sun Aug 9	Checkpoint 2 — Problems substantially modeled; draft notebook submitted to instructor only
Tue Aug 11	Final delivery — Notebook + recorded presentation (+ optional Streamlit link) delivered to your Client and the instructor
Wed Aug 12 – Fri Aug 14	Client Evaluation window
Fri Aug 14	Client Evaluation report due
Sun Aug 16, 11:59pm	Final revisions (optional, based on Client feedback) + all materials due